

1

Ontology

Leadership reality
appears through lived
and contextual
experience

2

Epistemology

Knowledge develops
through reflection and
interaction

3

Paradigm

Interpretive and
constructivist reading with
participatory action

4

Methodology

Qualitative descriptive
case study

The article does not explicitly name its ontology or epistemology; this reading follows its design and assumptions.

Research design

Research Philosophy and Methodology

One bounded coaching programme became the case

- Qualitative and descriptive approach
- Participatory action research
- Intrinsic case: understand this programme deeply
- Instrumental case: inform leadership development in the organisation

Participants and coaching process

Research Philosophy and Methodology

26

leaders invited

11

accepted

10

one-hour sessions

10

weeks

- Seven men and four women, aged 24 to 41
- Five Black and six White participants
- Convenience sample of advancement-potential leaders
- Coach observed one meeting chaired by each participant

From experience to findings

Research Philosophy and Methodology

1

Field notes

Recorded during and
after coaching

2

Reflective essays

About five pages from
each participant

3

Discourse analysis

Familiarisation,
categorising and
interpretation

4

Six themes

Working hypotheses
linked experience to
theory

Quality: peer review by two psychologists, prolonged engagement, consent, confidentiality and organisational permission.